

Morning desk briefing for April 9, 2026 — macro markets overview

MORNING DESK BRIEFING
Thursday, 9 April 2026 — Global Macro

RELIEF RALLY MODE

S&P 500 6,782 +2.51% yesterday	NASDAQ 22,635 +2.80% yesterday	WTI CRUDE \$94.41 −16.0% yesterday	GOLD XAU ~\$4,672 Consolidating	DXY 98.76 −0.05% soft
10Y YIELD 4.3% −10bps yesterday				

THE MORNING SQUAWK

Cautious bull ▼

Yesterday was a monster. Trump announced a two-week ceasefire with Iran, Hormuz reopens (partially), WTI dumps \$18 in a single session — biggest one-day drop since April 2020. The knee-jerk was clear: unwind geopolitical risk premium NOW. Dow ripped 1,325 points. Best day in a year.

But here's the thing — **this is a ceasefire, not a peace deal**. The tape is pricing in resolution. The real world is still figuring out shipping routes, tanker insurance, and inventory refills. Iran already said the US violated the agreement. That's your headline risk still live.

PAIN TRADE: The crowd is short oil, long tech. A ceasefire breakdown this week would obliterate both sides simultaneously. Watch your stops.

FOMC minutes flagged stagflation risk. GDP third estimate + PCE print TODAY. That's the next tape mover. Don't let yesterday's euphoria make you sloppy.

EQUITIES — SETUP & TRADE

Tactical long ▼

S&P 500 closed 6,782. The 200-day MA sits at 6,655 — the index is now above it, which is a regime change signal. When price reclaims the 200-day after a sustained period below it, algo systems flip from defensive to neutral and momentum funds chase. Next level: 50-day at 6,771 (already above it now). Clean air to 6,900+.

RSI at 46 — not overbought. Volume on yesterday's rip was solid across cyclicals. Death cross (50d crossed below 200d in late March) is still technically in place but losing its teeth fast.

Support 6,550 200d MA 6,655 Now 6,782 50d MA 6,771 Target 6,900–7,000

AI names ripped 4–10% (NVDA, META, TSLA, AMD, MU). Airlines surged on jet fuel logic — Delta up 6% on earnings beat. Industrials best sector +3.5%.

UBS cut year-end target to 7,500. Morgan Stanley says buy. The debate is pace, not direction — *if ceasefire holds*.

THE TRADE

Long S&P on dips to 6,655 (200d) with stop at 6,580. Target 6,950 over 2–3 weeks. Tactically overweight Industrials and AI mega-caps. Reduce Energy — oil risk premium is unwinding fast.

THE COMMODITIES PIT

Crude short-term bear ▼

WTI: \$94.41. Was \$118 at end of March. Down 20% in 10 days on ceasefire euphoria. Iran partial Hormuz reopening is the catalyst, but "partial" is the operative word — tanker traffic normalization takes weeks, not hours. Expect WTI to find a floor in the \$88–92 range near-term if the ceasefire holds. A breakdown in talks = snap back to \$110 instantly.

Gold: \$4,672/oz. Off the January ATH of \$5,595. Risk-off unwind is pressuring gold as equities melt up. Classic rotation. But stagflation + central bank buying (China 15 consecutive months) keeps the floor firm. \$4,400–\$4,500 is the new structural support if rates stay elevated.

WTI floor \$88–92 WTI ceasefire break \$110+ Gold support \$4,400 Gold ceiling \$5,000

THE TRADE

Fade the WTI rally on any bounce to \$98+ — ceasefire is priced in, supply normalization is not instant. On Gold: range-trade \$4,500–\$5,000. Buy dips. Don't chase the ATH but don't short it — stagflation backdrop is structurally bullish long-term.

FX DEALING ROOM

USD soft ▼

DXY at 98.76. Structurally weak — down from 108 a year ago, fiscal deficit now 6.5% of GDP. Guns & butter theory playing out in real time. Federal debt ceiling and \$2T deficit projections are a slow-motion dollar headwind.

USD/JPY: Carry trade under pressure. BOJ has been tightening while the Fed stays on hold at 3.50–3.75%. Yen strengthens when risk-off hits — watch 140 as the line in the sand. If equities falter, yen carry unwind = volatility spike everywhere.

EM / USD-IDR: Ceasefire is net positive for EM. Oil import relief for Indonesia. Expect IDR to firm modestly. But watch: core PCE print today. Hot print = Fed hawkish = DX Y bounce = EM pain trade reversal.

DX Y key level 97.50 / 101 Fed rate 3.50–3.75% 10Y yield 4.3%

THE TRADE

Short DXY on bounces toward 101 — structural deficit and ceasefire risk-on are headwinds. If PCE comes in hot today, that's a tactical DXY long opportunity — size accordingly. EM currencies (IDR, BRL) tactically bid if oil stays below \$100.

TODAY'S CATALYSTS — MOVES THE TAPE

High impact ▼

08:30 ET — Q4 GDP (3rd estimate) 08:30 ET — Feb Core PCE 08:30 ET — Initial Jobless Claims

After close — Constellation Brands (STZ) Tomorrow — March CPI (big one)

PCE: This is the Fed's preferred inflation gauge. Consensus is core PCE around 2.5% YoY. A hot print (2.8%+) means Fed stays higher for longer — stagflation narrative wins, rates spike, equities sell the news. A cool print = rate cut hopes reignite = melt up continues.

GDP Q4 3rd estimate: Expected near 1.4% annualized. Below consensus = weak demand = stagflation confirmed = gold bid, equities choppy.

Tomorrow March CPI is the headline risk event of the week. Set your vol exposure NOW.

THE TRADE

Into PCE: buy options protection on S&P (puts at 6,600). Post PCE: if cool print → add to equity longs. If hot print → trim equities, add gold, short DXY. Don't be a hero going into data naked. The ceasefire already gave you a 2.5% gift — protect it.

Not financial advice. For informational purposes only. All levels are analytical targets, not guarantees. Markets can and will make you look stupid.